

Beta Plan Document

Solar-R-Us LLC Commercial Solar Water Heating System

Beta Plan Overview

The beta will validate market fit, system performance, app usability, installation flow, support readiness, and sales messaging for the SRU solar water heating product line before launch.

Beta Planning Category	Completed Beta Plan Entry
Testing Purpose	Purpose: Validate that small, moderate, and large SRU solar water heating systems meet target customer needs before commercial launch. Desired results include validated efficiency, storage, flow, temperature control, app monitoring, setup, documentation, support process, and buyer value proposition. Test type: controlled pilot beta with representative commercial participants and selected residential/property-management observers.
Internal Readiness - Roles and Responsibilities	Product Manager Sarah Madison owns beta scope, success criteria, schedule, stakeholder alignment, and final recommendations. Product development and engineering observe system performance and resolve defects. UX designs usability testing and records user behavior. Marketing validates positioning and collateral. Sales observes demos and refines non-technical explanations. Manufacturing/operations validates component availability and delivery workflow. Customer support validates troubleshooting and help-desk readiness.
Tester Recruitment - Participants and Incentives	Participants will include at least one hospitality/property-management customer, one education or municipal facility, one light commercial facility, and selected residential/property owner users. Each participant will receive transportation support where needed, catered sessions for on-site tests, early-access installation scheduling, discounted system vouchers, and a post-test consultation showing expected ROI and energy savings.
Targets - Tester Contact Method	Testers will be contacted by telephone and email from SRU sales/account teams. Zoom will be used for remote confirmations and pre-test briefings. Attendance, NDA completion, venue instructions, and time slots will be confirmed by email.
Testing Objectives	Validate all core system features and functions for collector options, storage configurations, app controls, and installation setup. Validate system efficiency and large-system readiness. Validate usability by measuring learnability, efficiency, memorability, errors, and user satisfaction. Validate marketing value proposition and ROI messaging. Validate customer support workflow, documentation, and sales demo requirements.
Test Management and Venues	Testing will be conducted at SRU development/test site for controlled measurement and at selected customer pilot

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	locations where installation conditions can be observed. Small, moderate, and large prototype systems will be tested. Test sessions will include setup, app configuration, normal operation, low-energy mode, troubleshooting, ROI review, and feedback interview.
Communications Planning	Communications will use email, phone, Zoom, and an internal beta dashboard. Daily internal standups will review blockers, defects, and feedback. Testers will receive pre-test instructions, NDA reminders, schedules, post-session surveys, and follow-up summaries. Critical issues will be escalated to Product Manager, Engineering, UX, and Support within one business day.
Costs and Funding Sources / Approvals	Operations will fund venue setup, prototypes, logistics, transportation, catering, and data collection. Marketing will fund collateral prototypes and survey incentives. Product/engineering budget will fund instrumentation, defect correction, and app testing. Total planned beta budget: USD 25,000, subject to Product Manager, Operations, and Finance approval.
Scheduling	Beta plan approval: March 20xx. Pre-test recruitment and NDA completion: weeks 1-2. Controlled SRU site testing: week 3. Customer pilot observation: week 4. Results consolidation: by 30 April 20xx. Large-system app recognition fix: by 10 May 20xx. Engineering collector/storage modification: by mid-May 20xx. Launch readiness decision: one week before planned 25 May 20xx launch.
Legal Considerations	All external testers must sign NDAs, beta participation agreements, site access waivers, and consent for feedback collection. SRU must avoid unsupported performance claims until engineering validation is complete. Safety requirements, installation codes, data privacy for app telemetry, customer data handling, and warranty limitations must be reviewed by legal before launch.
Key Performance Indicators (KPI)	Minimum of four testers per participant group. Complete each formal test session within two hours. Test all three commercial system sizes and supported storage configurations. Achieve 95% pass rate for critical functions before launch. Resolve all severity 1 defects before launch. Achieve average usability satisfaction score of 4.0/5 or higher. Validate ROI calculator assumptions and document all feedback, defects, and findings.

Usability Testing Requirements

Category	Requirement
Learnable	First-time users should complete basic app setup, temperature review, and low-energy mode selection with minimal assistance. Note confusion points and update product design, manual, and onboarding.
Efficient	After initial learning, users should complete routine monitoring and settings tasks quickly; measure task time and reduce unnecessary steps.

Memorable	Returning users should be able to re-establish proficiency after time away using clear labels, illustrated guides, and in-app help.
Free of Errors	Document user errors, classify severity, identify root cause, and update app workflows, manuals, and installation instructions.
Delightful	Collect satisfaction feedback on app usability, aesthetics, setup clarity, energy-savings visibility, and buyer confidence.

References Used

Course scenario, Beta Plan Template, Usability Testing Requirements Worksheet, and scenario part IIIB update provided by the Product Management Capstone assignment.